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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the International Arbitration Paralegal role at the US law firm you are recruiting for, and my background maps directly onto what the role requires. I spent six months supporting international arbitration at BCLP, and I am currently completing an LLM in Comparative and International Dispute Resolution at Queen Mary.

At BCLP, I worked on a complex investment arbitration from an early procedural stage through to the Claimant's memorial. I reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions, amended sections of the memorial, drafted procedural orders and procedural histories, and conducted legal research on substantive issues. When the team lost another junior shortly before a significant deadline, I became the sole junior supporting the matter. I coordinated outstanding document tasks, tracked actions across the team, and helped ensure the submission was filed on time. A partner and associate both told me my performance was comparable to that of a newly qualified solicitor. That experience gave me a working understanding of how a major arbitration file is managed under pressure, which is exactly the kind of environment this role sits in.

The document management and research side of the role is also familiar to me. I maintained structured electronic case files throughout the arbitration matter, monitored procedural deadlines, and liaised with the client on required documents, including coordinating translations with an external translator in Romania. At Citizens Advice, where I currently advise clients on welfare, housing and employment matters, I manage cases from initial instruction through to submission, maintaining confidential records and drafting correspondence and procedural documents to deadline. The volume and pace are different from a law firm, but the discipline around file organisation and deadline management is the same.

My LLM has deepened the theoretical grounding for this work. I have studied international arbitration procedure, evidence in arbitration, and the procedural issues that arise in cross-border disputes. My dissertation focused on data protection and GDPR development across jurisdictions, and I attended London International Disputes Week at Three Crowns and a King's College London event on abuse of process in international arbitration, both of which developed my understanding of live procedural debates in the field.

This role is a natural next step. My practical arbitration experience at BCLP, combined with my LLM specialism, means I can contribute from day one rather than learning the practice area from scratch.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva